

realized we didn't lose much by eliminating dollars earned at our highest marginal tax rate. The combination of leveraging a part-time schedule and negotiating a work-from-home, location-independent position led her to like her job so much she decided she didn't want to retire. This actually gave me the confidence to leave my job even sooner and with more security than I otherwise would have.

Mini-retirements are another option. We introduced Noah and Becky, who write the blog *Money Metagame*, in Chapter 2. Becky is a neonatal nurse who found herself burning out on her demanding job. Only a few years into their careers, they were not in the position to retire and walk away from paid work forever. Fortunately, they had reached a level of FI that allowed them to step away from work for what they described as a "gap year." They decided to start their year away from work in January. Because taxes accrue on an annual basis, this gave them a full calendar year with almost no income. This time also gave them an opportunity for creative tax planning. They were considering options like a Roth IRA conversion, described in the next section, in a year when they would have little to no income.

Once you understand basic tax planning concepts and combine them with the flexibility FI offers, abundant tax planning options